

Playtest Instructions and Script

Please ensure that you have the “Playtesting Results Spreadsheet” document open to record responses and playtest data. Long responses can be summarized, but short answers should be verbatim.

Before beginning, ensure that the playtester has a working build of the game running on their computer.

PART 1: Playtester Information and Introduction

Please record the playtesters’ age and gender, as well as your relationship to the playtester, e.g. friend, classmate, coworker, etc. Name can be provided if desired but is optional.

Provide Instructions and Introduction to playtester as follows:

“Thank you for participating in our playtesting session. This session is anticipated to take approximately 15 minutes to complete. During this session, you will be playing the game Killer Robot, developed as a school project for the Video Game Development course at Georgia Tech. The purpose of this session is to gather valuable feedback on the development of our game. Killer Robot is a platformer-shooter featuring a robot playable character that becomes sentient and tries to escape from a factory that is creating killer robots.”

“Please play through the game knowing that the game is in development and is expected to have issues and flaws. Based on this, the more truthful your responses and the more feedback you provide, the more useful it will be to developing the game. Honest feedback, even if highly critical, is valued over telling testers and developers what you think that they might want to hear, so your honesty is appreciated in evaluating our game.

While you play the game, please speak aloud what you are thinking and doing. For example, if you are planning to take a certain action and trying to figure out how to do that, then please verbalize to me your thought process. I may prompt you during the session to keep sharing your thoughts. Otherwise, I will not generally speak during the gameplay session, instead testing whether the game itself can successfully provide the information needed to be played properly. The gameplay test session will last up to 5 minutes.”

PART 2: Instructions for Administrator during playtest

Observe a gameplay session either for 5 minutes or until game is completed by the player winning. Use a stopwatch to determine when 5 minutes passes and to record the time at

which the player wins, if they do. Do not use the in-game clock as this will reset on death or reset.

Start timing once the player begins the game, not while they are in menus. Advise playtester in neutral terms that they are welcome to read the information in the menu or can begin the game without looking, but please ensure that players know the controls before beginning the game. Jump = Spacebar, Shift = Sprint, Left Click = Fire Gun

Observe as the tester plays and take notes about what they say. Do not try to observe whether they are having fun based on indicators such as smiling or laughing, simply record their spoken responses and behavior within the game, aiming for objectivity over subjectivity.

During the playtest session, also keep a running count of how many times the player dies, and what they are killed by. Additionally, take notes on aspects of gameplay, e.g. if the player is struggling with something, does something unexpected, etc.

Take general fieldnotes to observe anything that you find interesting. If the playtester is silent for a time, please remind them to keep speaking aloud their thoughts. Do not coach the playtester or provide them information on anything related to the game. If the playtester speaks to you, simply remind them in a neutral way to focus on continuing to communicate their thoughts while playing the game.

You may intervene if the player gets stuck with the game in an unplayable state, such as stuck in a wall or dead and not sure how to restart, but do not provide help or hints with playing the game itself. Additionally, if asked about game controls, e.g. how to jump or spring, you may provide them with the input, but do not give them hints on how to utilize those abilities.

You may wish to record all field notes in the spreadsheet itself, or to use a paper notepad and then transcribe the information into the testing spreadsheet afterward if you prefer.

If the playtester finishes the game within 5 minutes, tell them that they are welcome to play again if they would like, but are not required to. If this happens, notate whether or not they choose to play again.

PART 3: Short Answer Gamefeel Questions

Read the following questions to the playtester. Do not discuss answers, simply ask the question and record their response.

SQ1: Which particular area of the game did you find most enjoyable? (Physical area, not aspect of the gameplay)

SQ2: What glitches or unintended effects, if any, stood out to you during your playtesting?

SQ3: Were there any portions of the game that you found too easy?

SQ4: Were any portions of the game too challenging?

SQ5: Which mechanics did you find most enjoyable? (Specific obstacles, enemies, platforming, etc)

SQ6: Based on the sample you have seen, describe the aesthetic of the game in a few words or a single sentence.

PART 4: Likert Scale Questions

Read the following questions to the playtester. Do not discuss their answers, but if they share additional comments, you may record them in Column C of the “Playtest Results Spreadsheet” document.

“Please answer the following questions using a scale of 1-5 where 1 represents strongly disagree, 2 represents somewhat disagree, 3 represents a neutral response, 4 represents somewhat agree, and 5 represents strongly agree.

In the interest of providing the best data for further development, please answer truthfully—it is more helpful to get accurate feedback than to hear responses that flatter us.”

LQ1: The game has an appealing visual style.

LQ2: The gameplay mechanics lend themselves to enjoyable play.

LQ3: The game provided me with a strong sense of what my goals were, and what steps to take to achieve those goals.

LQ4: I found myself confused while playing.

LQ5: The game had serious issues with bugs / glitches that impacted my enjoyment or ability to play.

LQ6: I found combat with enemies enjoyable in the game.

LQ7: I found platforming (jumping, navigating the course, and dodging obstacles) enjoyable in the game.

PART 5: Open Ended Questions

OQ1: What main thing(s), identifying between 1 and 3, would you identify as most in need of improvement?

OQ2: Are there other particular features that you would like to see implemented?

OQ3: Are there any other thoughts on the game or project that you would like to share?